



FREE GUIDE · FOR NURSING HOMES & LTC

The Nursing Home / LTC Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Unused resident controls, insulin sharps, and
med returns — handled safely and documented.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Unused resident meds pile up.

Nursing homes and LTC facilities accumulate unused resident medications — including controlled substances after a resident is discharged or passes — plus insulin and injection sharps, blister-pack returns, and red-bag biohazard. Safely destroying unused controls, with documentation, is both a compliance duty and a diversion-prevention must. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take your unused resident meds and controls — by mail-back or on-site deactivation — plus sharps and biohazard, with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Unused resident controlled substances — especially after discharge or death — the highest diversion-risk stream.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unused resident Schedule II–V meds
- Wasted & partial doses
- Discontinued controlled orders

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs; on-site deactivation meets non-retrievable guidance.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, or on-site deactivation, to DEA standards.

Tip

On-site deactivation lets you render controls non-retrievable immediately — useful when meds shouldn't leave the building.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste

Blister-pack and unit-dose returns and expired resident medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blister-pack & unit-dose returns
- Expired non-controlled resident meds
- Discontinued medications

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or on-site deactivation.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

Sharps

Insulin, injection, and finger-stick sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Insulin pens & needles
- Injection syringes
- Lancets

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Wound-care and incontinence-related regulated waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked dressings
- Contaminated PPE
- Wound-care biohazard

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The nursing home / LTC compliance checklist.

- ☐ Unused resident controls logged, rendered non-retrievable (mail-back or on-site), with Form 41.
- ☐ Blister-pack and unit-dose returns destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Insulin and injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Wound-care biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS LTC FACILITIES ASK

Your LTC questions, answered.

How do we destroy unused controlled meds after a resident passes?

Render them non-retrievable — either mail them back for destruction or use an on-site deactivation kit — and complete a DEA Form 41. Prompt, documented destruction prevents diversion.

Can we deactivate meds on-site?

Yes — on-site deactivation kits render medications non-retrievable immediately, which is useful when meds shouldn't leave the facility.

How do we handle blister-pack returns?

Non-controlled returns are destroyed as pharmaceutical waste with documentation.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle serves nursing homes and LTC by prepaid mail-back kits, on-site deactivation kits, or scheduled pickup — unused resident meds and controls, sharps, and biohazard — destroyed with a Certificate of Destruction and Form 41 handled. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Unused resident controls	Controlled destruction / on-site deactivation (Form 41)
Blister-pack / med returns	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Insulin / injection sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Wound-care biohazard	Biohazard mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

LTC volume often favors scheduled pickup with centralized records over mail-back. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY NURSING HOMES & LTC FACILITIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your nursing home waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop